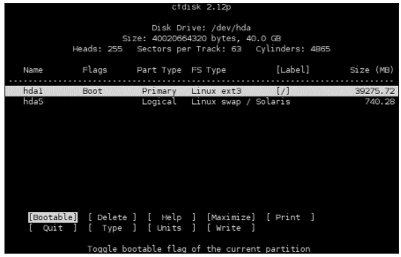
holds true for working with any disk management tool. You can format a drive in almost every file system that is existing today.



The cfdisk utility

fdisk is the most commonly-used disk partition viewing tool. If you want to see all your partitions, the quickest way to do so is to use the “fdisk -l” command.

3.2.1.2 View and change hard disk information

hdparm is used to get or set hard disk parameters. Some of the settings you may make here may not be compatible with the hard disk. If you see a warning that says the operation might be risky, it is best avoided.

3.2.1.3 Checking for disk errors

fsck is used to check and repair a Linux file system. It is advised that only unmouted partitions be checked by this tool.

3.2.1.4 Mounting hard disk partitions

As discussed earlier, the following codes represent hard disks connected in different configurations:

Primary Master - First IDE hard disk - hda
Primary Slave - Second IDE hard disk - hdb
Secondary Master - Third IDE hard disk - hdc
Secondary Slave - Fourth IDE hard disk - hdd

Further, the first partition on a disk is represented by 0, the second partition by 1 and so on. Hence, hdb2 refers to the third partition on the second IDE device (primary slave). If you don’t know which partition you wish to mount, you can get the parition information of all connected hard disks via the “fdisk -l” command and then proceed to mount. The “mount” command is used